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UNITED STATES SUPREME COURT

State mail-in ballot rules upheld

Illinois and others can count them after Election Day

By Rick Pearson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The U.S. Supreme Court ruled Monday that Illinois and other states can continue to count mail-in ballots cast by Election Day that arrive afterward, rejecting a challenge by President Donald Trump and Republicans to require ballots be delivered to election authorities by the date of the November general election.

In a 5-4 ruling authored by Justice Amy Coney Barrett, a Trump appointee, the court’s

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Election judges process and count mail-in ballots at the Board of Elections in Chicago in 2024. The U.S. Supreme Court ruled Monday that Illinois and other states can continue to count mail-in ballots cast by Election Day that arrive afterward, rejecting a challenge by President Donald Trump and Republicans. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Ruling expands presidential powers on firing leaders of federal agencies

Justices grant exception for the Federal Reserve

By Mark Sherman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court on Monday dramatically expanded presidential power, upholding President Donald Trump’s firings of the heads of independent federal agencies with one important exception: the Federal Reserve.

The justices allowed Fed governor Lisa Cook to stay in her job while she fights the Republican president’s effort to fire her over allegations of mortgage fraud, which she has denied.

But other than at the nation’s central bank, with its role of setting interest rates, the court held that presidents have free rein to fire agency heads at will, despite federal laws that require a cause for such dismissals and a 91-year-old decision that had limited executive authority.

With the six conservative justices in the majority, the nine-member court jettisoned its unanimous decision in Humphrey’s Executor that had limited when presidents can fire agencies’ board members — in part to try to ensure decision-making free of political influence.

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ELECTION 2026

Two fight to stay on ballot in 4th District

Independents battle to remain amid claims of machine politics

By Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Two independent candidates aiming to give voters more choices in the Illinois 4th Congressional District race are still fighting to keep their names on the November ballot — casualties, they say, of the same hardball political maneuvering that delivered the Democratic nomination to outgoing U.S. Rep. Jesús “Chuy” García’s hand-picked successor.

Mayra Macías and Ald. Byron Sigcho-López each turned in far more than the 10,816 signatures required to run as independents against Democratic nominee Patty García. But after García’s allies filed objections to their petitions, both campaigns have been consumed by an expensive, time-pressured scramble to collect affidavits from their petition signers, leaving little room for anything else.

The setting of the campaign has temporarily shifted from the streets of Chicago’s Little Village and Pilsen neighborhoods, as well as several western suburbs that make up the 4th District, to stale government conference rooms, where Macías and Sigcho-López have in recent weeks been arguing to stay on the Nov. 3 ballot.

“The biggest frustration that I have with this process is that we’re so focused on the process of getting on the ballot that we don’t have time to talk policy, that we don’t have time to focus on substantive issues,” Macías said Friday before a ballot status hearing in Chicago.

The race was set in motion last fall when U.S. Rep. Jesús “Chuy” García — at the last minute before a filing deadline last fall — announced he would not seek reelection, clearing the path for Patty García, his now-former chief of staff and no relation, to secure the Democratic nomination in March. The move drew rebukes from critics across the political spectrum who accused the retiring congressman of bypassing voters.

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“It’s been fairly infrequent that we see a three-day duration of heat like this. We’ve seen it two times since the beginning of 2013 up until this point.” — **MIKE BARDOU**, meteorologist with the National Weather Service office in Romeoville



Alberto Rodríguez cools off with his daughters Heaven, 3, and Emari, 6, in a water spray during an extremely hot day on Monday in Chicago’s West Humboldt Park neighborhood. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Precautions urged as heat wave grips Illinois

Warnings issued amid 3 days of heat indexes over 100 degrees in forecast

By Evgenia Anastasakos
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

At 57th Street Beach in Chicago, people laid out towels on the sand and waded into the calm water to escape the heat. Lifeguards watched over the crowded scene.

Ashburn resident Morhfa Wells went to the beach to cool down. Although he said the weather is tolerable so far, he’s not excited for the next few days of extreme temperatures.

“I’m not a big heat person,” he said.

Wells remembers the 1995

Chicago heat wave — the deadliest weather event in Illinois history, killing 739 people.

“It was just miserable,” he said. “I think I spent the majority of my time inside.”

He expects to do the same this week.

Across Chicago and the suburbs, preparations were underway for dangerously high temperatures this week as officials urged residents to take extra precautions. The National Weather Service issued an extreme heat warning, effective from noon Monday through 10 p.m. Wednesday.

At a Monday news conference led by the city’s Office of Emergency Management and Communications, meteorologist Mike Bardou of the National Weather Service office in Romeoville said the warning was issued in anticipation of three consecutive days with a peak heat index of 100-105 degrees F.

The heat index combines atmospheric temperature and relative humidity to determine how heat feels to the body.

“It’s been fairly infrequent that we see a three-day duration of heat like this. We’ve seen it two times

since the beginning of 2013 up until this point,” Bardou said.

He said the sudden temperature swing doesn’t help.

“The other condition that we’re concerned about is that it’s been relatively cool. A lot of us are acclimated to relatively cooler weather, and this quick change to hot and humid conditions can definitely take its toll on the body,” Bardou added.

Overnight temperatures are expected to stay in the upper 70s to 80s, Bardou said, offering people

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Johnson presses tenants’ rights

Mayor added pressure to aldermen as they began to vet his plan to overhaul Chicago renters’ rights with changes like capped move-in fees. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Fast-food celebrations of America

As America’s 250th birthday nears, what could be more fitting than a giardiniera-infused hot dog, fried apple pie or a fireworks-topped mini Bundt cake? **Business**

Iran, US disagree on talks status

United States and Iran separately announced they will send delegations to Qatar, though Tehran insisted it has not agreed to meet with the U.S. **Nation & World**

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